Punjab Daanish Schools and
Centers of Excellence Authority
Government of the Punjab

No. M(Admin/HR&Coord)/1940/02/2017/5090

14. February 2017

To

The Principals,
Daanish School (Boys and Girls),
Chishtian, Hasilpur, Rahim Yar Khan,
Attock, D.G.Khan, Mianwali and Rajanpur.

Subject: **Medical Policy for Students**

Medical Policy for students is attached herewith as Annexure-A for implementation in true letter and spirit, please.

Lt Col (R) Jawad Ahmad Malik
Manager(Admin/HR&Coord)

Cc:

1. Vice Chairman, PDS & CEA.
2. Academics Department, PDS &CEA
3. Finance Department, PDS & CEA.

MEDICAL POLICY FOR STUDENTS

1. **General.** Daanish Schools are catering to the educational and residential needs of a large number of students in both boy and girl campuses. Catering to health and hygiene needs of these students hailing from extremely poor back ground is a major challenge, since understanding and application of hygiene and disease prevention is universally low across the disadvantaged sections of society. This policy lays the guidelines for all Daanish schools under Daanish Authority to keep their students and staff healthier and address the medical issues of students.

2. **Principle.** It must be borne in mind that 'Healthy bodies bear healthy minds. The basic principle employed in the schools will be that 'Prevention is Better than Cure".

3. **Aims & Objectives.** Following are major aims and objectives of the policy. Implementing this policy will provide students and staff:

   a. Basic awareness about diseases through primary health education
   b. Disease free, protected and safe environment
   c. Healthy and hygienic environment
   d. Immediate response, care and medical treatment for sick students
   e. Good standard of health and hygiene.

4. **Health Education - Prevention of Diseases.** Since illness causes loss in health, academic performance, resources, etc, an important aim in schools should be educating students about basic health and first aid. Following shall be ensured:-

   a. Students shall be provided hygienic, safe and clean environment.
   b. Classrooms and dorms/hostels shall be airy and properly ventilated.
   c. Students shall know importance of personal hygiene (cleanliness of body, hands, feet, hair, nails, eyes, nose, ears and all sensitive areas, etc).
   d. Students shall wash their hands with soap before and after meals
   e. Students shall be trained to brush their teeth before breakfast and after supper.
   f. Washrooms, generally the haven of diseases, shall be made especially clean.
   g. Students shall not share their towels, socks, vest, undergarments, nail cutter, tooth brush, trimmers, etc. with other students.
   h. Use of razor or blade is strictly Banned in school. Only personal trimmer can be used if need be but these would never be shared with anyone.
   i. A meticulous 'Health Record' shall be maintained by the Doctor on each student of the school.

j. The Principal will ensure that the doctor trains the nursing, house and sports staff in cardio-pulmonary resuscitation drills.

k. House staff will guide the students in remaining well-hydrated by ensuring regular drinking of water.

l. Any house management staff member carrying infectious or contagious disease will be immediately sent on Sick Leave and a substitute appointment made forthwith. The case will also be referred to Head Office. A house management staff member carrying contagious/infectious disease that requires treatment for more than 2 months, will be discharged from service.

5. **Policy for New Admissions (Class-6th)**

a. Administering of following medical tests will form an essential part of admission process:-

(1) Blood CP

(2) X-Ray (for TB, Heart & Lung diseases, etc)

(3) Hepatitis B & C screening test (HBsAg & Anti HCV)

(4) HIV

b. Medically unfit students (i.e. ones suffering from contagious / infectious diseases) will not be granted admission.

c. Record of all the tests be kept in student's dossiers and MI Room.

6. **Medical Staff & Medical Facilities.** All Daanish Schools shall employ:

a. 1x Doctor with minimum qualification MBBS

b. 2x Dispenser

c. 1x Nursing Assistant/attendant

d. 1x Dispensary [Medical Inspection (MI) Room]. MI room will be maintained in all schools with basic medical facilities to cater for medical needs of the students round the clock.

e. A proper first aid box will be maintained in Dispensary/MI room.

f. Detention facilities will be created in MI room.

7. **Treatment of Diseases.** Sick students shall be treated immediately. A prompt response by all concerned (mentioned under role of different appointments) will ensure safety of students during illness. The School Doctor shall be overall responsible for the healthcare of the students. Medical staff will remain available on duty during office hours and on call during after-office hours. Principals will ensure that the medical staff is accommodated close to the dispensary. Accurate and prompt response of medical staff will save students from minor and major life threats due to diseases and accidents. All school

personnel, especially Housemasters, are responsible to report any such case immediately to the School Doctor.

8. **General Mode of Treatment/Diagnosis of Diseases.** Following will be the mode of treatment in Daanish Schools:-

a. Common diseases (such as influenza, diarrhea, malaria, typhoid) shall be treated by the School Doctor in school dispensary (MI Room).

b. The doctor may refer students for preliminary diagnosis / tests to the nearest Government Hospital, THQ, DHQ or Division hospital after seeking permission from the Principal.

c. In case of non-availability of facility or urgent need of reports required, he/ she may send students for clinical tests from private clinic / lab after the permission of the Principal

d. In case a facility is not available in the nearest Government hospital and nature of disease/accident demands immediate treatment and tests of student, medical doctor can send student to some private hospital / recognized private medical practitioners/doctor after approval of the Principal. For this purpose, the Principals are authorized to spend a maximum of Rs. 20,000/- per child for one-time treatment of a student for any particular disease. Students may be referred to Govt. hospitals located in major cities in case of acute medical problems (say, when medical facilities are not available in nearby locality/city).

e. School transport can be used for sick students.

f. School medical staff will accompany the students to local, tehsil, district and divisional hospitals as and when required. In case of parents of students are available, the Principal on advice of the doctor will decide whether the school medical staff will accompany the student.

g. Parents of students shall be immediately informed about any disease carried by his/her child, which is contagious, serious or prolonged.

9. **Treatment of Serious Diseases**

a. Serious diseases shall be treated as 'Emergency'. Infected student shall be immediately shifted to the nearest Government hospital.

b. The selection of the hospital shall be based upon condition of the student, distance of the hospital, nature and level of the disease, facilities available at the hospital and level of threat to life. Life–threatening diseases include heart diseases/stroke, Chronic pulmonary disease, lower respiratory infections, cancers of all kinds, HIV AIDS, Diabetes Mellitus, Hepatitus B & C, etc).

c. Parents of sick students should be called and it should be ensured that parents are accompanied in case of treatment from hospital. Hospital undertaking forms should be signed by parents.

d. Epilepsy cases to be identified and treated. In case of incapacity to treat, these may be discharged from the school.

e. If it is determined that detention of students suffering from any acute disease requires special arrangements, like special diet, specialized care and treatment, etc which may not be possible in school, such students should be sent home after initial treatment immediately for dedicated medication/treatment.

10. **Treatment of Contagious & Infectious Diseases.** Owing to the disadvantaged background of the students, exposure to contagious diseases during vacation cannot be ruled out. The risks of a disease spreading in a residential institution are both likely and grave. Therefore, extreme precautions must be employed to prevent spread of a disease. Following actions will be taken by the school administration upon suspecting / discovery of a student infected with contagious/infectious disease:-

a. Immediate test from the nearest recognized laboratory/hospital.

b. In the meanwhile, the housemaster will ensure the following

(1) The affected student will be immediately quarantined to prevent the spread of disease to other students/staff.

(2) All his personal items and utensils in his/her use as well as daily consumable items like towels, toothpastes, clothes, etc shall be kept separate.

(3) Separate arrangements will be made for him/her to dine.

(4) The clothing of the student shall be separated and washed with detergents/Dettol etc.

(5) All his belongings will be kept in open for exposure to the sun daily.

(6) His cupboard will be thoroughly cleaned and disinfected.

c. Upon verification of the infection:-

(1) The student will be immediately sent on Sick Leave for treatment.

(2) His parents will be called and advised by the Principal about the school's support in the treatment of the student (covering transport, stay, medicines, etc used during treatment up to Rs 20,000/-). In case the confirmation of disease through test comes during exam time, maximum caution will be exercised for quarantine. Prior coordination will be made with parents/guardians to send the student on Sick Leave on the day of the last exam after he finished attempting his/her paper.

(3) The school shall provide the parents medicines for seven days to start his treatment.

d. The school management will ensure regular monitoring of the affected student/s and call him back as soon as he is cured.

e. The school management will maintain a proper record of payment incurred during the process of treatment.

f. The student shall only be allowed to resume regular studies with other students after conduct of an additional medical test from a recognized hospital/laboratory to ensure that he/she is free of disease.

11. **Treatment of Major & Life Threatening Diseases.** For diagnosis and treatment of life-threatening diseases, the affected student will be referred immediately to the nearest hospital. The parent/guardian of the student will be informed urgently. In such cases, the case will be referred to the Head Office immediately for decision.

12. **Accidents.** In case of any minor and major injury or accident, students shall be:

a. Immediate first-aid will be provided on site of accident and the student evacuated to dispensary, if required.

b. The student shall be immediately shifted to the nearest hospital, if required.

13. **Provision of Medicines / Equipment**

a. The school doctor shall be solely responsible for availability of necessary life-saving medicines (including anti-venom for rabies or dog-bite, and snake/scorpion-sting). Date of expiry of medicines is to be checked every time before use by the doctor.

b. The school doctor will be responsible for availability of all necessary first-aid and related valid medicines in the dispensary at all times.

c. The doctor will process a written request on a Demand Register seven days before the end of the stock of medicines to the Head of Purchase Committee.

d. After approval by the Head of Purchase Committee, the register will be forwarded to the Principal, who will mark it to Admin Officer for procurement/purchase of medicines and provide them to the doctor.

e. The timely provision of medicines to the doctor will be treated by Admin Officer as 'Top Priority'.

f. The doctor will satisfy himself with the quality/validity of the medicines.

g. A similar process will be followed for procurement of other medical/related equipment for dispensary. Ensuring the quality of such items will be the responsibility of the school doctor.

h. The Principal will ensure avoidance of wastage and keeping within the limits of school medical budget.

14. **Administering Medicine to the Students**

a. Treatment can be effective only if students take medicine properly and according to the prescription. Proper medication also saves purposeless use of medicine budget.

b. No medicine shall be handed over to the students. No student shall be allowed to keep medicine of any nature with him/her in the house. All medicines prescribed by doctor will be handed over to House Superintendent/matron in an envelope carrying student name. He/she (House Superintendent/matron) will keep medicines in his custody and administer it to the student after meals in the mess hall. Tags will be attached with the medicines (mentioning the name/number of student &class, etc) to avoid mixing up.

15. **Record of Medicine**

a. Record of medicines purchased, medical treatment (including diagnosis) will be maintained for each student in dispensary and in the personal files of the students by the School Doctor and Housemaster respectively.

b. Proper stock-taking of medicines on ledger shall be carried out monthly by the Doctor and shall be weekly signed by the Admin Officer.

c. Ledgers shall be put up to the Principal for signature on monthly basis.

16. **Responsibilities.** All staff members are instructed to efficiently fulfill any related lawful duty assigned to them by the Principal.

Principal

a. The Principal shall assume overall responsibility for ensuring that all structures, staff and students on the campus are in clean and hygienically satisfactory condition. He will do so with effective use of his staff.

b. He / She will be responsible for providing regular and well-organized lectures on different important aspects of healthcare.

c. He / She shall visit sick students and conduct periodic checks of dispensary and its stock.

d. Establishing highly effective system of health education for students, maintaining hygiene standards and disposal of medical cases.

e. In case of non-availability of a doctor on campus, clear instructions be given to nurses/ dispensers by the Principal regarding treatment of general diseases (diarrhoea, malaria, typhoid,etc).

f. In case of a viral infection, students/ staff members be instructed to avoid close interaction among one another.

g. As Geometry boxes have compasses, therefore these need to be kept in teachers' resources room/custody and provided to students when required under due supervision. Similarly, the use of common pins is completely disallowed in the school premises.

h. Regular sick-report timing should also be observed (i.e. After Breakfast till start of 1st period of academic session). This will help the students with minor disease not lose out on academics.

Admin Officer

a. Cleanliness of the campus, houses and academic block, particularly sensitive areas such as washrooms, cooking area, etc.

b. Control/prevention of unhygienic conditions, like puddles, sewers, etc. Proper disposal of sewerage waste, filth/ garbage, especially mess waste/ remaining food, to be ensured.

c. Cookhouse, dining hall and especially the tandoor area should be dust and insect-free. All utensils shall be neat and clean. Special care should be ensured in washing of crockery, cutlery and cooking pots (use of anti-bacterial dish wash and hot water). Purpose-built mess/ dish washing areas to be established ensuring overall hygiene and cleanliness. Electric Fly/ Insect Killer should be installed in Mess/ Dining Halls.

d. Regular checks (including frequent spot checks) on cleanliness of cooks and associated staff. They should wear neat & clean clothes, should cover the head and must cut nails weekly. Waiters and waitresses to put on face masks.

e. Anti-bacterial soap/ hand wash to be used in mess hand washing area.

f. Ensure water reservoir are kept clean and maintenance of water filtration plant (if any) is regularly carried out. Ensure six-monthly Laboratory test of drinking water. Serviceability of geysers for having warm water for students during winters (Dec to Feb).

g. Medical tests of all mess staff after every six months. These tests will include Blood CP, X-Ray (for TB, Heart & Lung diseases, etc) and Hepatitis B & C screening test (HBsAg& Anti HCV). The first detailed medical check-up will be carried out at the time of selection.

h. Medical tests of all other academic/non-academic staff in month of January every year. These tests will include Blood CP, X-Ray (for TB, Heart & Lung

diseases, etc) and Hepatitis B & C screening test (HBsAg& Anti HCV). First detailed medical check-up will be carried out at the time of selection.

i. Ensure that the Daily Duty Teacher checks and writes his / her observation in the report. All observations in this respect will be brought to the notice of the Principal.

j. Regular cleaning of washrooms and toilets through janitors with necessary chemicals be ensured.

k. Regular contact with Tehsil / District Headquarter Hospital authorities.

l. Timely provision necessary medicine/equipment to the Doctor.

m. Provision of transport facility to shift student to the hospital, including managing availability of ambulance for emergencies, if required.

n. Special care to be adopted for Laundry of bed sheets. Bleach/ anti-bacterial may be used for Laundry.

o. Only trimmers are used by barbers. No use of razor blade/safety razor be allowed in at the Barber's. Barbers tool should be sterilized.

p. Fumigation / Insecticide spray of Academic Block. Student Houses. School Offices and residential area in coordination with TMO during spring vacation and towards the end of summer vacation.

School Doctor. The School Doctor plays the most vital role in keeping students healthy. The School Doctor shall be responsible for:-

a. Proper and expeditious diagnosis of diseases. In case of any chance of an epidemic break out, informing the Principal immediately.

b. Ensure ready presence during office hours and being on call during after-office hours. Ensure the presence of medical staff during office hours. Take rounds of dorms to visit sick students.

c. Maintain duty roster of medical staff and ensuring their presence on duty in the dispensary round-the-clock.

d. Ensure the duty of his staff at the grounds during sports time. Staff should carry first aid box for any emergency.

e. Deliver phased-wise duly programmed lectures on health-related issues, hygiene and sanitation, personal hygiene and cleanliness and precautionary measures against common diseases like skin diseases, malaria, dengue, typhoid and hepatitis etc.

f. Ensure that necessary medical-related information is displayed on the notice boards of dispensary, houses & academic block.

g. Respect privacy of all students/staff and maintaining strict confidentiality in all official matters. Similarly, all kinds of observations be brought to the Principal's notice immediately.

h. Detailed periodic individual medical inspection of students, with no more than 3 month gap between each inspection.

i. Ensure that hygienic environment is being provided by the relevant officials by carrying out regular/periodic inspection of the different areas of the campus, especially washrooms, cookhouses, hostels, etc.

j. Conduct regular inspection of the mess staff.

k. Ensure through house staff that there is no self-medication being carried out by students on the campus. Advise spot checks to house management for checking on students bringing medicine from their homes.

l. Assess corporal punishment of students through physical examination and reporting immediately to the Principal.

m. Be on the look out for abnormal case (say, addiction, smoking, etc).

n. Ensure proper and careful administration of medicine to the students. He will also maintain complete record of medicines administered to the student.

o. He will hold a minimum level of stock of medicines for 7 days and ensure that medicines purchased have minimum one month validity. He will maintain the Stock Register of medicines as well as a record of expired medicines before separating from the normal stock.

p. Thus, ensuring the quality and quantity of medicines and medical equipment in dispensary is his responsibility.

q. Forwarding demand for medicines to the Principal on as required basis and ensuring that the medicines are received in the shortest time possible through Admin Officer.

r. Maintaincomprehensive medical record of each student and staff member (including record of students' eyesight).

Housemaster/Mistress

a. Refer a sick student of his house to the Doctor immediately and follow up on his condition. House Superintendent/matron shall take ill students to the doctor/dispensary.

b. Deal with sick students of the house with care and compassion. Manage special diet, if prescribed by the doctor for sick students of the house. Accompany sick student to the hospital if required and visit them in the hospital (if any) as frequently as possible.

c. Carry at least two detailed inspections of house, washrooms attached with house and surrounding premises daily at different times of the day to ensure complete cleanliness. Keep strict checks to ensure uncompromising standards of neatness and hygienic conditions. Get washrooms of the house cleaned with chemicals daily and with acids on weekly basis by the sweepers.

d. Ensure frequent inspections of the dorms to check for food items brought by the parents/guardians that may cause health issues/hazards. Manage the house staff to perform their optimum.

e. Have students observe one earmarked day of the week as 'Maintenance Day', when they will clean all their lockers, belongings, surroundings/specified areas of the house. Ensure spreading bedding items in sunshine once every 15 days

f. Personal Hygiene

(1) Keep strict checks on personal hygiene standards of students. Assess their personal hygiene through their visible parts (i.e. nails, feet, etc).

(2) Ensure that the periodic personal medical inspection is carried out by the school doctor.

(3) Ensure that each student takes regular bath, cuts his nails, brushes twice daily, cleans his feet, keeps short hair, washes hands before meals as a habit, etc. Advise young students on unfamiliar areas of personal cleanliness.

(4) Instill in students a habit of staying clean. Ensure bathing by all the students daily, especially before going to bed/school, after sports period and as necessary.

(5) Ensure strictly that students do not must not share under garments, tooth brushes, trimmers, towels, etc of other students.

(6) Train the students on how to use commode/wc, keeping due care of hygiene. Instill in them a habit of cleaning the washroom after use.

(7) Ensure that students take proper care of feet, change and wash their socks daily to avoid skin diseases.

(8) Ensure that students keep their shoes in sunshine once in a week to keep them germ-free.

(9) Students should not keep with them razors / blades, knives or any kind of medicines.

(10) There should be no self-medication in campus. Students are not allowed to bring medicine from their homes unless allowed by the School Doctor & submitted with the HM (Housemaster)

(11) Ensure that eyesight of students is regularly tested.

g. A housemaster has to deal with growing kids. Keep strict checks on unnatural habits, attitudes and activities that could lead to sickness. Report such instances immediately to the Principal. Ensure with utmost effort that students of different classes do not mix. Carry out spot checks at night for any unusual movement, etc. Awareness regarding child abuse / sexual harassment be imparted. Encourage shy students to inform about their sickness/diseases as well as unnatural/unusual incidents.

h. Inform immediately to the Principal regarding any serious health issue of students. The same should be put in writing on a 'House Report Register' and put up to the Principal ASAP.

i. Have House Superintendent/matron shall be responsible to administer medicine to the sick student(s) in the mess after meal themselves to avoid misuse of medicine. They will maintain a proper record for this. House Superintendent/matron be instructed to inform to the housemaster/mistress about illness of any student immediately. At no moment should a sick student of the house be out of sight of house staff.

Prefects

a. Inform house superintendent/matron and housemaster immediately about any sick student of the house

b. look after sick students of the house and provide proper care

c. take serious sick students to the doctor without waiting anyone

d. inform next day to the Deputy head about serious sick students

Assistant Admin Officer

a. Cleanliness of the campus, houses and academic block, particularly sensitive areas such as washrooms, cooking area, or wherever unhygienic conditions are likely to spread, like swamps, sewers, etc.

b. Regular cleaning of washrooms and toilets through janitors with chemicals.

Dispenser / Nurse

a. Be available in the dispensary (MI Room) on duty, as prescribed, to provide immediate care and response to the students and staff.

b. Provide medicine prescribed by the doctor to the superintendent/matron and the students.

c. Tackle emergencies and support the doctor

d. Maintain ledgers as advised by the doctor.

e. Maintain a list of medicines, required and available in stock on daily basis.

f. Make himself available at playgrounds during sports time.
g. Maintain a list of expired medicines and separate them from normal stock.
h. Look after students and staff in the absence of doctor but seek guidance through telephone. He will not prescribe any medicine without the doctor's advice.
i. Act on doctor's any other lawful instructions

Nursing Assistant

a. Be available in the dispensary on duty as prescribed to assist the doctor and dispenser
b. Be responsible to keep dispensary neat, clean and tidy
c. Act on doctor / Nurse's any other lawful instructions

House Boy/Girl

a. Keep dorms and washrooms clean using sweepers.
b. Look after the sick students.
c. Continuously check/stay with a sick student if he/she is serious.
d. Accompany the sick student to the hospital, if required.
e. Provide full support to the superintendent/matron.

Role of Mess Staff. Role of mess staff in keeping students and staff healthy is very important. Therefore, Admin Officer and Mess Incharge will ensure that they stay neat and clean. That they wear cap enclosing their hair while on duty and gloves while handling food stuff, cooking or serving food. That they have proper haircut and cut their nails. Mess staff should not have any contagious disease. A mess staff member carrying contagious disease shall not be allowed to work in the mess and be removed from the service immediately. Principal will forward a case to this effect to the Head Office.

Janitorial Staff. Janitor staff plays a key role in keeping environment of the school hygienic, healthy and clean. Under instructions of Admin Officer (followed by frequent regular checks), they will keep environment neat, clean and tidy; keep washrooms of academics and houses dry, neat and clean round-the-clock. They will wash all washrooms daily with detergents and chemicals and with acid once a week. They will clean and swipe all dorms daily and wash the complete house completely periodically.